

Extended Kalman Filter Tuning in Sensorless PMSM Drives

Silverio Bolognani, *Member, IEEE*, Luca Tubiana, and Mauro Zigliotto, *Member, IEEE*

Abstract—The use of an extended Kalman filter (EKF) as a nonlinear speed and position observer for permanent-magnet synchronous motor drives is a mature research topic. Notwithstanding, the shift from research prototype to a market-ready product still calls for a solution to some implementation pitfalls. The major and still unsolved topic is the choice of the EKF covariance matrices. This paper replaces the usual trial-and-error method with a straightforward matrices choice. These matrices, possibly combined with a novel self-tuning procedure, should put the EKF drive much closer to an off-the-shelf product. The proposed method is based on the complete normalization of the EKF algorithm representation. Successful experimental results are included in the paper.

Index Terms—AC motor drives, extended kalman filter (EKF) tuning, permanent-magnet synchronous motor (PMSM) drives, sensorless drives.

I. INTRODUCTION

THE extended Kalman filter (EKF) is an optimal estimator in the least-square sense for estimating the states of dynamic nonlinear systems, and it is, thus, a viable and computationally efficient candidate for the online determination of rotor position and speed of a permanent-magnet synchronous motor (PMSM) [1]–[4]. Theoretical basis and digital implementation of the EKF have been deeply investigated [2], [3], [5]. However, at least one major drawback of the EKF application to sensorless drives is still unsolved, which is the design and the tuning of the covariance matrices that appear in the EKF equations.

Covariance matrices account for model approximation and measurement noise. They can be obtained by considering the stochastic properties of the corresponding noises. Since these are usually unknown, in most cases the EKF matrices are designed and tuned by trial-and-error procedures. Skilled personnel varies the matrix elements in a range of several decades, in order to get the best fit for the specific application. Indeed, it is the customization required by each application that makes most of the EKF-based drives incompatible with an off-the-shelf market strategy.

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S. Bolognani is with the Department of Electrical Engineering, University of Padova, 35131 Padova, Italy (e-mail: bolognani@die.unipd.it).

L. Tubiana and M. Zigliotto are with the Department of Electrical, Management and Mechanical Engineering, University of Udine, I-33100 Udine, Italy (e-mail: tubiana@uniud.it; zigliotto@uniud.it).

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This paper proposes a novel approach to the EKF settings for sensorless PMSM drives on the perspective of an industrial application. The idea has born from the consideration of both drive control and motor electromechanical design aspects. It is first worth noting that by adopting a suitable normalization, the PMSM parameters with isotropic rotor vary in a narrow range, regardless of motor size. If a coherent normalization of the EKF algorithm is accomplished as well, the covariance matrices of the filter would generally fit for almost all standard PMSM drives. This smoothes the way toward an off-the-shelf-oriented production, with the related benefits in the drives marketplace.

Of course, optimal sensorless drive performances can be achieved by a further on the field fine tuning of the EKF covariance matrices. But it is worth to highlight that, opposite to the actual practice, the proposed method gives an effective and general initial guess for EKF matrices settings. Eventually, it will be proved that on-the-field refinements could be obtained by a particular application of the well-known Bartlett test, performed at first startup of the drive.

The validity and the generality of the proposed EKF setting method have been tested by experiments on different laboratory prototypes.

II. NORMALIZED DRIVE EQUATIONS

A. Motor Equations

Normalized equations are obtained by dividing each variable of interest by the corresponding base value.

Primary base quantities are the torque T_B , the electrical speed Ω_B , and the maximum phase voltage U_B at the maximum power point of the constant torque region. Derived base quantities, such as motor parameters and current base values are fixed by equating the electrical power $(3/2)I_B U_B$ to the mechanical one $T_B \Omega_B / p$, where p denotes the number of pole pairs. The complete set of base values is reported in Table I.

It is worth noting that the base value for the position is $\vartheta_B = 1$. Angular position is, thus, the only quantity unaffected by the normalization, that is to say, every sinusoidal quantity has a repetition period of 2π . In the following, normalized quantities will be denoted by the superscript “ n .”

Let us assume a stationary orthogonal reference frame (α, β) fixed to the stator. The two stator currents, the electrical speed and position are used as system state variables

$$\mathbf{x} = [i_\alpha \quad i_\beta \quad \omega \quad \vartheta]'. \quad (1)$$

By defining the vector of system base states

$$\mathbf{x}_B = [I_B \quad I_B \quad \Omega_B \quad \vartheta_B]' \quad (2)$$

TABLE I
BASE VALUES FOR THE NORMALIZATION

Base quantity	Symbol	Value
Current	I_B	$2T_B\Omega_B/(3pU_B)$
Flux	Λ_B	U_B/Ω_B
Inductance	L_B	Λ_B/I_B
Resistance	R_B	U_B/I_B
Viscous coeff.	B_B	pT_B/Ω_B
Inertia	J_B	pB_B/Ω
Angle	ϑ_B	1 rad
Time	t_B	$1/\Omega_B$

the i th element of the normalized state vector $\mathbf{x}^n$ can be simply obtained by

$$x_i^n = \frac{x_i}{x_{Bi}}, \quad i = 1 \dots 4 \quad (3)$$

with obvious meaning of symbols. The system input and output are the phase voltages and current, respectively,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{u}^n &= [u_\alpha^n \ u_\beta^n]' \\ \mathbf{y}^n &= [i_\alpha^n \ i_\beta^n]'. \end{aligned} \quad (4)$$

With the above assumptions and for a better matching to the EKF equations, the PMSM model equations can be rearranged in a canonical state-space form as

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{\mathbf{x}}^n &= \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}^n, \mathbf{u}^n) + \mathbf{v}^n \\ \mathbf{y}^n &= \mathbf{H}\mathbf{x}^n + \boldsymbol{\mu}^n \end{aligned} \quad (5)$$

where bold characters are used for vectors and matrices.

The normalized model and measurement disturbances are statistically described by the zero-mean Gaussian noises $\mathbf{v}^n(t)$ and $\boldsymbol{\mu}^n(t)$, whose variance matrices are $\mathbf{Q}^n$ and $\mathbf{R}^n$, respectively.

The functional $\mathbf{f}$ is given by

$$\mathbf{f} = \begin{bmatrix} \Omega_B \left(-\frac{R_s^n}{L_s^n} i_\alpha^n + \frac{\Lambda_{mg}^n \omega^n}{L_s^n} \sin(\vartheta^n) + \frac{u_\alpha^n}{L_s^n} \right) \\ \Omega_B \left(-\frac{R_s^n}{L_s^n} i_\beta^n - \frac{\Lambda_{mg}^n \omega^n}{L_s^n} \cos(\vartheta^n) + \frac{u_\beta^n}{L_s^n} \right) \\ 0 \\ \Omega_B \omega^n \end{bmatrix} \quad (6)$$

where R_s^n and L_s^n are the normalized motor resistance and inductance.

By imposing that the normalized torque, speed, and voltage are all unity during operation at the maximum power point of the constant torque region, the normalized motor current is given by

$$I^n = \frac{1}{\Lambda_{mg}^n} \quad (7)$$

and the following relationship arises between stator inductance and PM flux linkage:

$$L_s^n = \Lambda_{mg}^n \sqrt{1 - (\Lambda_{mg}^n)^2}. \quad (8)$$

The developed torque is due to both the PM flux linkage and the stator current. In order to limit the latter, the PM flux linkage is normally designed as closely as possible to its highest feasible value.

By considering several typical PMSM designs, it can be noted that the normalized parameters usually vary in the ranges

$$\Lambda_{mg}^n = 1 \div 0.9 \quad L_s^n = 0 \div 0.4 \quad I^n = 1 \div 1.1. \quad (9)$$

It is also worth noting that the leftmost boundary is only theoretical, since it refers to the ideal case of unity normalized PM flux linkage that in turn corresponds to unity power factor. Since (9) is a fundamental hypothesis for the developments of this work, an extended verification on PMSMs with different size and parameters has been carried out preliminarily. Appendix I reports the results, which are in full agreement with (9). It is also worth noting that (9) holds for isotropic, surface-mounted magnet motors, which by far represent the majority of the PMSM production.

Internal PM (IPM) motors, with anisotropic rotor structures, have also been investigated. Larger variations of normalized parameters occur, and this, together with the inherent nonlinearity of the inductance due to saturation effects, calls for further deepening, before the proposed procedure can be extended to IPM motors.

It is very important to highlight that the narrow ranges exhibited by the normalized motor parameters in (9) will make the EKF matrices largely independent of different motors parameter sets, resulting in matrices $\mathbf{Q}^n$, $\mathbf{R}^n$ of widespread validity.

B. EKF Equations

The model described by (5) is formally identical to the motor model before normalization. Therefore, the EKF algorithm [2], [3] can be straightforwardly applied, by manipulating normalized quantities.

As it becomes clear from (6), the dynamic model of the motor is derived under the so-called “infinite inertia” hypothesis, that is, the speed variation within each control cycle T_c is considered negligible with respect to the other variables dynamics. With this assumption, any mechanical load parameter, as well as the load torque, disappear from the equations of the model, for the sake of algorithm robustness.

For a correct digital implementation, the system (5) is first linearized around the best available estimate $\mathbf{x}e_o^n$ [3]. Let $\mathbf{F}$, $\mathbf{B}$ and $\mathbf{H}$ be, respectively, the state, the input, and the output matrices of the linearized system.

At time $t_k = kT_c$ the optimal state estimate $\mathbf{x}e_{k|k}^n$ and the estimation error covariance matrix $\mathbf{P}_{k|k}^n$ are obtained through a simplified version of the EKF algorithm [3], summarized in Table II.

It is possible to demonstrate that between natural and normalized values for the EKF covariance matrices the following relations hold:

$$p_{ij}^n = \frac{P_{ij}}{x_{Bi}x_{Bj}} \quad q_{ii}^n = \frac{Q_{ii}}{(x_{Bi})^2} \quad r_{ii}^n = \frac{R_{ii}}{(x_{Bi})^2} \quad (10)$$

where $i, j \in [1 \dots 4]$ and x_{Bi} is the i th element of system base states vector (2).

TABLE II
EKF ALGORITHM

Prediction step
$\mathbf{x}e_{k k-1}^n = \mathbf{x}e_{k-1 k-1}^n + [\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}e_{k-1 k-1}^n) + \mathbf{B} < \mathbf{u}_{k-1}^n >] T_c$
$\mathbf{P}_{k k-1}^n = \mathbf{P}_{k-1 k-1}^n + (\mathbf{F}_{k-1} \mathbf{P}_{k-1 k-1}^n + \mathbf{P}_{k-1 k-1}^n \mathbf{F}_{k-1}') T_c + \mathbf{Q}^n$
Innovation step
$\mathbf{x}e_{k k}^n = \mathbf{x}e_{k k-1}^n + \mathbf{K}_k^n [\mathbf{y}_k^n - \mathbf{H} \mathbf{x}e_{k k-1}^n]$
$\mathbf{P}_{k k}^n = \mathbf{P}_{k k-1}^n - \mathbf{K}_k^n \mathbf{H} \mathbf{P}_{k k-1}^n$
Kalman gain
$\mathbf{K}_k^n = \mathbf{P}_{k k-1}^n \mathbf{H}' (\mathbf{H} \mathbf{P}_{k k-1}^n \mathbf{H}' + \mathbf{R}^n)^{-1}$

TABLE III
NORMALIZED PI REGULATORS

PI Laplace definition
$PI^n(s) = K_p^n + \frac{K_i^n}{s}$
Proportional Gain (Current Loop, subscript “ <i>i</i> ”)
$K_{p,i}^n = \frac{K_{p,i}}{R_B} = \omega_{oi}^n L_s^n \sqrt{1 + (\omega_{oi}^n T_c^n)^2} = 0.5$
Integral Gain
$K_{i,i}^n = \frac{K_{i,i}}{R_B \Omega_B} = K_{p,i}^n \frac{R_s^n}{L_s^n} = 0.128$
Proportional Gain (Speed Loop, subscript “ <i>o</i> ”)
$K_{p,o}^n = \frac{K_{p,o}}{R_B} = \frac{2\omega_{oo}^n J^n \sqrt{1 + (\omega_{oo}^n / \omega_{oi}^n)^2}}{3pA_{mg}^n} = 3.11 \times 10^{-3}$
Integral Gain
$K_{i,o}^n = \frac{K_{i,o}}{R_B \Omega_B} = K_{p,o}^n \frac{B^n}{J^n} = 3.43 \times 10^{-6}$

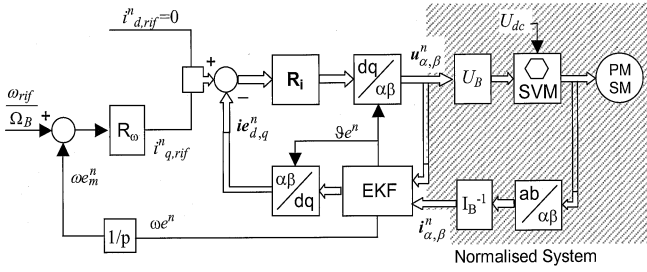


Fig. 1. Sensorless PMSM drive with normalization.

III. DRIVE STRUCTURE

The structure of the PMSM sensorless drive proposed in this paper is shown in Fig. 1, where the normalized system has been put in evidence.

An accurate compensation of any nonlinearity of the space-vector modulation (SVM) inverter has been carried out. This makes possible the use of voltage references instead of measured voltages, with further reduction of the number of sensors.

Both speed and current loops have a control cycle $T_c = 125 \mu s$, as it is a satisfactory tradeoff between algorithm efficiency and microprocessor load factor.

Current control is performed in a (*d*, *q*) synchronous coordinates system, fixed to the rotor PM. Two identical proportional–integral (PI) regulators have been designed and tuned to get a bandwidth $f_{oi} = \omega_{oi}/(2\pi) = 400$ Hz. Similarly, the PI speed regulator’s parameters have been set considering a bandwidth $f_{ow} = \omega_{ow}/(2\pi) = 20$ Hz.

PI constants are related to both the system parameters and the required bandwidth. Moreover, proper determination of the normalized values of the proportional and integral action for speed loop has required an approximate knowledge of the total friction and inertia. For the experiments, the motor and load together featured $J^n = 11.32$ and $B^n = 0.05$.

The normalized expressions of all selected PI parameters are reported in Table III.

The normalization of each regulator constant has been performed by considering the physical dimension of the constant itself. For example, proportional gain is supposed to produce a voltage reference having a current error as input and, therefore, it is similar to a resistance. This is the reason why the normalization is carried out by the division by R_B .

IV. DESIGN AND TUNING OF $\mathbf{Q}$ AND $\mathbf{R}$

A critical point during the design of the EKF is the choice of the elements of the covariance matrices $\mathbf{P}_0$, $\mathbf{Q}$, and $\mathbf{R}$, which affect the performance and the convergence as well.

The diagonal initial state covariance matrix $\mathbf{P}_0$ represents variances or mean-squared errors in the knowledge of the initial conditions. Varying $\mathbf{P}_0$ yields different amplitude of the transient, while both transient duration and steady state conditions will be unaffected [2]. Matrix $\mathbf{Q}$ gives the statistical description of the drive model. Increasing $\mathbf{Q}$ would indicate the presence of either heavy system noise or increased parameter uncertainty. An increment of the elements of $\mathbf{Q}$ will likewise increase the EKF gain, resulting in a faster filter dynamic. On the other hand, matrix $\mathbf{R}$ is related to measurement noise. Increasing the values of the elements of $\mathbf{R}$ will mean that the measurements are affected by noise and thus they are of little confidence.

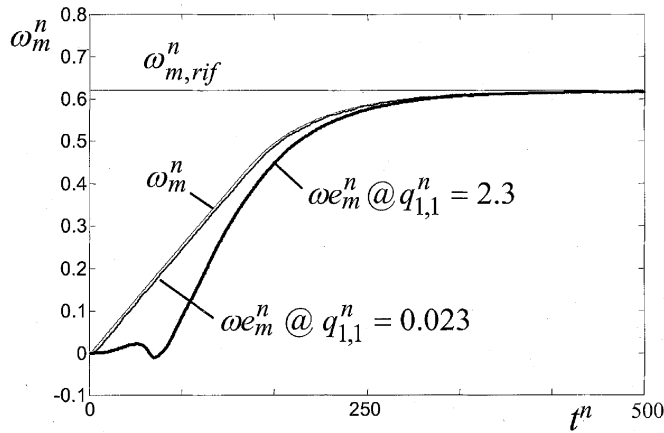
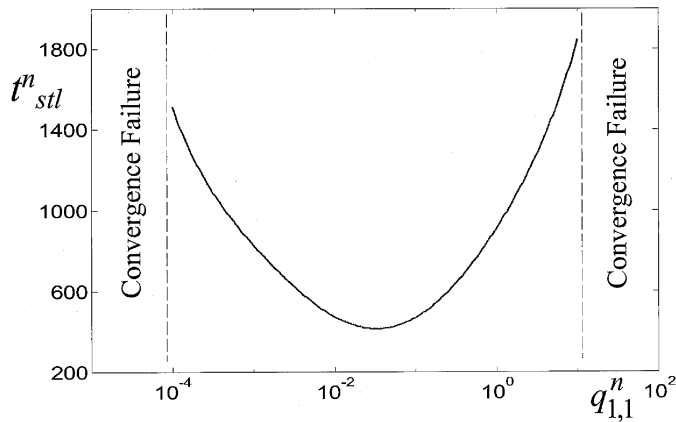
Consequently, the filter gain $\mathbf{K}$ will decrease, yielding poorer transient response.

It is a common practice to assume the covariance matrices $\mathbf{Q}$, $\mathbf{R}$, and $\mathbf{P}_0$ to be diagonal, for the lack of sufficient statistical information to evaluate their off-diagonal terms [1]–[3]. On the other hand, practice has revealed that even starting with nonzero off-diagonal values, at steady state off-diagonal terms remain several times smaller than the corresponding diagonal terms.

It can be realized that both $\mathbf{Q}$ and $\mathbf{R}$ depend on the drive parameters, the sampling time, the measurements amplitude, and some other secondary factors.

The advantage of the proposed approach is that the appropriate design and tuning of $\mathbf{Q}$ and $\mathbf{R}$ made for a PMSM drive works well for any other drive with similar sampling time. It has also been experienced that the EKF behavior is not influenced by different SVM techniques.

Simulations and experimental tests on a drive prototype can derive appropriate ranges of normalized elements of the covariance matrices. The first step of matrices tuning is to consider an open-loop drive in which speed and current loops are closed around measured quantities. It is found that, without modifying

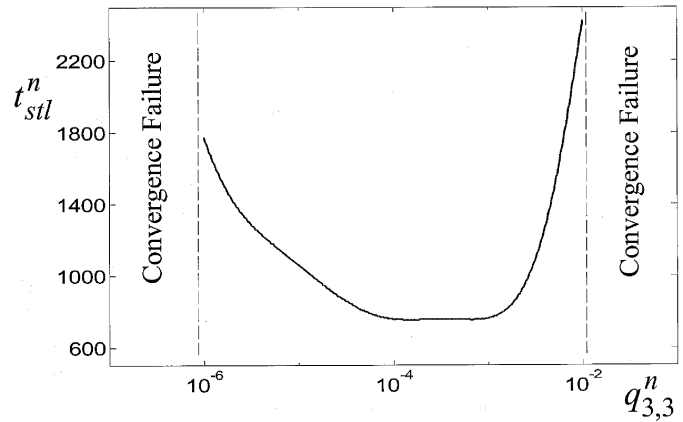
Fig. 2. Speed at different $q_{1,1}^n$ (sensored system).Fig. 3. Settling time versus $q_{1,1}^n = q_{2,2}^n$ ($\Omega^n = 0.25$, $T^n = 0.21$).

PI regulators parameters, the effect of covariance elements variation is clear. Owing to negligence of the mechanical equation in the Kalman filter model, the estimated speed always delays the actual speed. This delay depends on the model covariance matrix $\mathbf{Q}$. Taking into account the behavior of the open loop EKF to a speed reference step, it is found that the lower normalized elements $q_{1,1}^n = q_{2,2}^n$ of $\mathbf{Q}^n$, the lower the delay of the estimated speed in comparison with the effective one.

The aim of the first batch of experiments was devoted to find out the range of values that reduces the delay of the EKF response, being careful that small values of $q_{1,1}^n$ mean a high reliability of the motor model and this could not be verified by the experimental drive. Fig. 2 shows actual and estimated speed step response for different values of $q_{1,1}^n$, with control loops closed on measured quantities, and by fixing $q_{3,3}^n = 4.6 \times 10^{-4}$, $q_{4,4}^n = 0.1$.

The control loops are then closed on the estimated speed and position quantities both in the computer simulations and in the laboratory prototype. The normalized settling time t_{stl}^n of the speed step response has been used to evaluate the EKF closed loop behavior at different $q_{1,1}^n$. Fig. 3, obtained on the laboratory prototype, reports the settling time subsequent to a small speed step variation around a steady-state condition, as a function of the parameter $q_{1,1}^n$.

The tuning procedure is not linked to the particular working point, as inferred by several measurements carried out on proto-

Fig. 4. Settling time versus $q_{3,3}^n$ ($\Omega^n = 0.375$, $T^n = 0.56$).

types. For increasing torque values, an increment of the settling time is experienced, while the value of element $q_{1,1}^n$ that minimizes the settling time slightly varies, indeed.

As a result, for different values of T^n , the curve of Fig. 3 shifts up or down, without evident shape variations. As regards the working speed, it is well recognized that higher speed leads to a more reliable motor model. This is due to the greater influence of the back electromotive force in the voltage equations of the PMSM, in comparison to the resistive and inductive voltage drops. Therefore, the prediction step is more reliable and the range of the element $q_{1,1}^n$ that minimizes the settling time extends symmetrically, and proportionally to the working speed.

The working point indicated for Fig. 3 has been selected to get best sensibility to the tuning of $q_{1,1}^n$. Actually, lower values of torque (down to the no-load condition) or speed (down to the minimum working speed, at about $\Omega^n = 0.12$) yield both unchanged convergence range and optimal $q_{1,1}^n$ value.

The minimum settling time is, thus, obtained for $q_{1,1}^n = 0.023$, for which the speed versus time behavior is similar to a first-order response. For higher values of $q_{1,1}^n$ a marked overshoot appears. The delayed response of the filter corrupts the closed loop response up to instability, experienced for $q_{1,1}^n > 10$.

Similar considerations hold for the element $q_{3,3}^n$, whose relationship with the settling time is reported in Fig. 4, maintaining $q_{1,1}^n = 0.023$ and $q_{4,4}^n = 0.1$.

From no load to $T^n = 0.56$ the curve shifts along the ordinates axis, but the $q_{3,3}^n$ element range that corresponds to the minimum settling time remains unchanged. Greater values of torque do not cause instability, while saturation in the current regulators can temporarily occur, invalidating the settling time measurement. As regards the speed, from the minimum speed allowed by sensorless operations $\Omega^n = 0.12$ up to $\Omega^n = 0.375$ the curve of Fig. 4 remains unchanged. As for Fig. 3, at greater speed values only an enlargement of the optimal $q_{3,3}^n$ range is measured.

Small values of $q_{3,3}^n$ cause instability or swinging, while greater values involve strongly noisy signals but not convergence failure. Above $q_{3,3}^n = 0.01$ instability arises. There is anyway a quite broad range in which similar drive performance can be obtained.

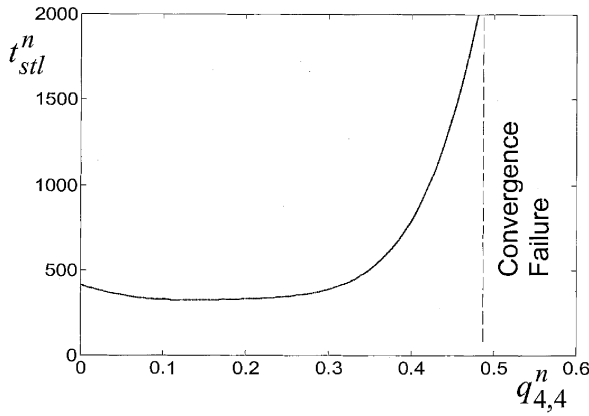


Fig. 5. Settling time versus $q_{4,4}^n$ ($\Omega^n = 0.25$, $T^n = 0.21$).

It has been found that the element that most influences the EKF convergence is $q_{4,4}^n$; values in the range from 0.01 to 0.5 assure filter convergence and a good dynamics. In this case, the curve is quite independent from the working point. Fig. 5 reports the settling time as function of $q_{4,4}^n$, maintaining $q_{1,1}^n = 0.023$ and $q_{3,3}^n = 0.46 \times 10^{-3}$. The convergence failure appears around $q_{4,4}^n = 0.5$. Some measurements have been carried out to test the robustness of the proposed EKF tuning to variations of the sampling time, which is usually related to the switching frequency of the inverter. It has been found that the EKF tuning is insensible to increments of up to 40% of the sampling time T_c .

From these considerations it follows that the normalized Q^n matrix that yields the best results on the laboratory prototype is

$$Q^n = \begin{bmatrix} 0.023 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.023 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0.46 \cdot 10^{-3} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0.1 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (11)$$

Matrix R^n concerns the measurements noise. Both simulation and experimental tests on the prototype point out that values in the range

$$r_{1,1}^n = r_{2,2}^n \in [0.2 \times 10^{-3}, 5] \quad (12)$$

do not significantly influence the EKF behavior. Extremely high values of R^n increase the convergence time up to instability. An alternative guideline is to fix $R = I$, I being the identity matrix. For the system used in the experiments, it yields a normalized matrix R^n given by

$$R^n = \begin{bmatrix} 0.023 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.023 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (13)$$

The condition $R = I$ allows a remarkable savings in the recursive calculation of the estimate error covariance matrix $P_{k|k}$. In details, for $R = I$, it is easy to prove that the following equivalences hold for the innovation step:

$$p_{1,1}^n = k f_{1,1}^n \quad p_{2,2}^n = k f_{2,2}^n \quad p_{1,2}^n = k f_{1,2}^n \quad (14)$$

and $p_{2,1}^n = p_{1,2}^n$. Equation (14) reduces by 30% the number of sums and by 20% the number of product operations of the EKF algorithm.

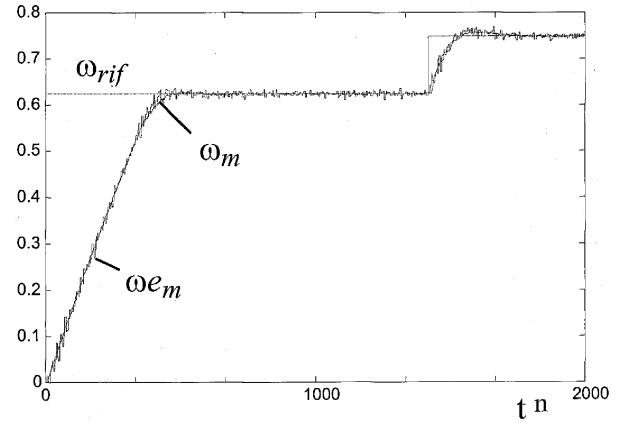


Fig. 6. Speed response with Q^n , R^n , P_0^n .

As mentioned before, the initial guess for P_0 slightly influences the EKF behavior. The following normalized matrix has been used in this work:

$$P_0^n = \begin{bmatrix} 0.04 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.04 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 71 \times 10^{-6} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 10 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (15)$$

Fig. 6 shows the actual and estimated speed of the EKF sensorless prototype with the above calculated covariance matrices.

Experimental results perfectly match simulation outcomes, as a mark of the accuracy of this research.

V. BARTLETT TEST

A refinement of the design of the covariance matrices of the EKF algorithm can be obtained by a particular application of the Bartlett test. Let us define the steady-state current prediction error as the difference between measured and predicted values of phase currents.

According to Kalman's theory, if there exists a matrix Q that makes that prediction error to be a white stochastic process, then that Q makes the predictive algorithm reported in Table II to be optimal.

In the Bartlett test, the ideal integral of the prediction error spectrum density is a straight line with a slope proportional to the current variance. The degree of whiteness of the actual process can be evaluated as the displacement of the real integral with respect to the ideal line. As an example, Fig. 7 shows the Bartlett test performed on current ie_α^n during the on the field tuning of the Q^n matrix element $q_{1,1}^n$.

The Bartlett-optimal value $q_{1,1}^n = 0.023$ is confirmed by the quasilinear behavior of the integral of the spectrum density, that is evidence of the whiteness of the current prediction error. Bartlett optimal Q^n matrix varies with the working point of the motor. Experiments have shown that $\Omega^n = 0.2$ and $T^n = 0.32$ is the steady-state working point with the best sensibility to the Bartlett test.

On the other hand, it has been experienced that fine tuning performed far from the mentioned working point did not assure good dynamic performance in the whole operating range of the drive.

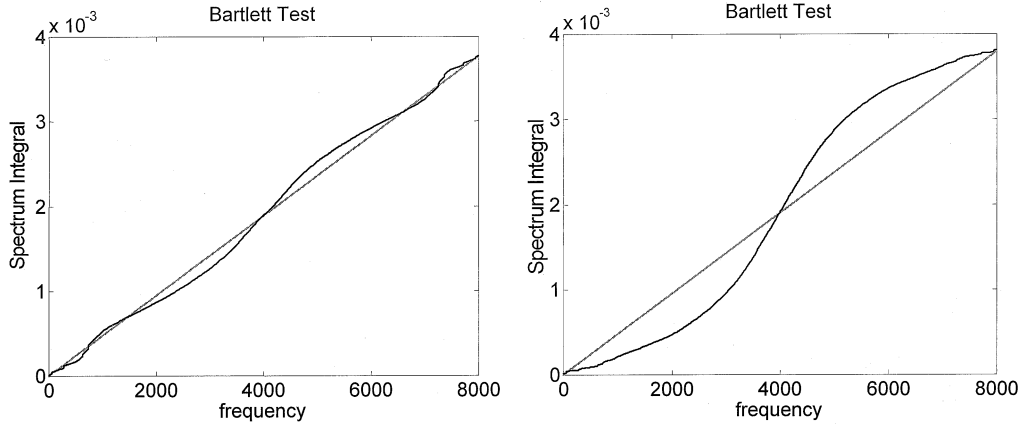


Fig. 7. Bartlett test on ie_α^n during the tuning of Q^n matrix (left: $q_{1,1}^n = 0.023$; right: $q_{1,1}^n = 1.15$).

TABLE IV
LIST OF SYMBOLS

x	System state vector
xe	Estimated state vector
u	System input vector
Y	System output vector
B	Linear system input-state matrix
$f(x,u)$	System state functional
$F(x(t)) = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \bigg _{x=x(t)}$	Jacobian of system state functional
H	System output matrix
K	Kalman gain matrix
P	State error covariance matrix
Q	Model noise covariance matrix
R	Measurement noise covariance matrix
i	Stator current vector
ie	Estimated stator current vector
R_s	Stator resistance
L_s	Stator inductance
Λ_{mg}	PM flux linkage
T_c	Sampling period
p	Motor pole pairs
ω, ϑ	Electrical rotor speed, position
ω_e, ϑ_e	Estimated electrical speed, position
ω_m	Mechanical speed
ω_{em}	Estimated mechanical speed
Subscripts, superscripts	
d, q	Synchronous frame quantities
α, β	Stationary frame quantities
k	Sampling index
$k k-1$	Predicted estimate
$k k$	Optimal estimate
0	Initial value
$'$	Transposed matrix
ref	Reference quantity
B	Base quantity
n	Normalised quantity

TABLE V
PMSM MOTORS DATA (FIRST BATCH)

PMSM	#1	#2	#3	#4
Torque	0.5	2	8	8
Ω [radel/s]	628.3	628.3	471.2	314.2
I [A _{rms}]	1.3	5	13.7	9.2
L [mH]	5.65	1.65	0.70	1.60
R [Ω]	5.25	0.735	0.155	0.335
E [V _{rms}]	80.55	83.78	91.73	91.06
U [V _{rms}]	89.31	89.88	95.57	95.94
pole pairs	4	4	4	4
T_B [Nm]	0.50	2.00	8.00	8.00
U_B [V]	126.30	127.10	135.16	135.68
Ω_B [radel/s]	2513.3	2513.3	1885.0	1256.6
I_B [A]	1.66	6.59	18.59	12.35
Λ_B [Vs]	0.05	0.05	0.072	0.108
L_B [mH]	30.3	7.67	3.86	8.74
R_B [Ω]	76.16	19.28	7.27	10.99
Λ_{mg}^n	0.902	0.932	0.960	0.949
L_s^n	0.186	0.215	0.182	0.183
I^n	1.1	1.07	1.04	1.05

matrices that should roughly fit for most of the standard PMSM drives, overcoming the pitfall of a trial-and-error tuning. Secondly, a procedure for the fine tuning based on a whiteness test was proposed.

Experimental tests, performed on working prototypes, have confirmed the validity of the procedures.

VI. CONCLUSION

A novel procedure for the tuning of covariance matrices in EKF-based PMSM drives has been presented. The procedure addresses surface-mounted magnet PMSMs, which are the most common in the market place. The key feature is the combined normalization of both the controlled system model and the EKF algorithm. The first result is a proposal of normalized covariance

VII. LIST OF SYMBOLS

See Table IV. Bold characters are used for vectors and matrices. The symbol $\langle \rangle$ is used to indicate mean value in the interval from t_k to t_{k+1} .

TABLE VI
PMSM MOTORS DATA (SECOND BATCH)

PMSM	#5	#6	#7	#8
Torque	24	96	240	320
Ω [radel/s]	209.4	125.7	125.7	83.8
I [A _{eff}]	21	43.5	62.3	51
L [mH]	1.20	1.05	1.38	1.41
R [Ω]	0.13	0.07	0.067	0.047
E [V _{eff}]	79.79	92.44	161.37	175.22
U [V _{eff}]	85.17	98.21	168.68	179.23
pole pairs	4	4	3	4
T_B [Nm]	24.00	96.00	240.00	320.00
U_B [V]	120.45	138.89	238.55	253.47
Ω_B [radel/s]	837.8	502.7	377.0	335.1
I_B [A]	27.82	57.91	84.28	70.51
Λ_B [Vs]	0.144	0.276	0.633	0.756
L_B [mH]	5.17	4.77	7.51	10.73
R_B [Ω]	4.33	2.4	2.83	3.59
Λ_{mg}^n	0.937	0.941	0.957	0.978
L_s^n	0.232	0.220	0.184	0.131
I^n	1.07	1.06	1.04	1.02

TABLE VII
PMSM MOTOR DATA (PROTOTYPE)

Quantity	Value
Nominal torque T_B [Nm]	2.8
Nominal speed Ω_B [radel/s]	1680
Nominal power P_B [kW]	0.909
Phase voltage U_B [V _{rms}]	84.8
Nominal current I [A _{rms}]	5
Poles pairs	4
R_s (@ 50°C)	1.5
L_s	3.5
PM Flux linkage Λ_{mg} [Vs/rad]	0.066

APPENDIX PMSM MOTORS DATA

Tables V–VII report the main electrical and electromechanical data for eight different PMSM motors. This sample has been selected to test the validity of the assumptions (9).

The second batch, with increased values of torque, is reported in Table VI.

The sensorless PMSM drive described in the paper has been implemented on a TMS320C31 TI digital signal processor. Table VII reports the data of the motor used in the experimental stage of the work.

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Silverio Bolognani (M'76) is a native of Trento Province, Italy. He received the Laurea degree in electrical engineering from the University of Padova, Padova, Italy, in 1976.

In 1976, he joined the Department of Electrical Engineering, University of Padova, where he was involved in the analysis and design of thyristor converters and synchronous motor drives. He later founded the Electrical Drives Laboratory, where various research on brushless and induction motor drives is carried out in the frame of European and national research projects. He is presently engaged in advanced control techniques for motor drives and motion control and on design of ac electrical motors for variable-speed applications. His teaching activity is devoted to electrical drives and electrical machine design. He is currently Full Professor of Electrical Converters, Machines and Drives and Head of the Department of Electrical Engineering. He is the author of more than 100 papers on electrical machines and drives.

Prof. Bolognani is presently Chairman of the IEEE IA/IE/PELS North Italy Joint Chapter. He has served as a member of the steering or technical committees of numerous international conferences.



Luca Tubiana is a native of Conegliano, Italy. He graduated in electrical engineering (first-class honors) from the University of Padova, Padova, Italy. His degree thesis concerned the development of sensorless techniques for electrical drives. He is currently working toward the Ph.D. degree in industrial and information engineering in the Electric Drives Laboratory, University of Udine, Udine, Italy.

His main research interest concerns sensorless and advanced control strategies for brushless motors.



Mauro Zigliotto (M'88) is a native of Vicenza, Italy. He received the Laurea degree in electronic engineering from the University of Padova, Padova, Italy, in 1988.

He worked in industry, developing microcontroller-based control systems for electric drives. From 1992 to 1999, he was a Senior Research Assistant in the Electric Drives Laboratory, University of Padova. Since 2000, he has been with the Department of Electrical, Management and Mechanical Engineering, University of Udine, Udine, Italy, where he is an Associate Professor of Electric Drives. His main research interest concerns innovative control strategies for ac motors, and he has published extensively in this area.

Prof. Zigliotto is the Secretary of the IEEE IAS/IES/PELS North Italy Joint Chapter.